FREE GUIDE · KRISTINE MAIA

The 5-minute desk stretch

5:00
START THE TIMER

Four spots. One chair. No equipment.

Neck, shoulders, wrists and hips: the places a long day of sitting hits first. Start a 5-minute timer, move slowly and keep every stretch gentle. A comfortable pull is right. Sharp pain is a stop sign.



1 Neck — 1:20

Chin tucks — 8 slow reps
Sit tall and glide your chin straight back, like a gentle double chin. Hold 2 seconds.

Side neck stretch — 20 s each side
Ear toward shoulder. Hold the chair seat with the other hand to keep that shoulder down.



2 Shoulders — 1:00

Shoulder rolls — 8 rolls
Lift, roll back and let the shoulders melt down. Big, slow circles, backwards only.

Shoulder blade squeeze — 8 reps
Pull your shoulder blades back and down, hold 3 seconds, release.



3 Wrists — 1:10

Palm-up stretch — 15 s each hand
Arm straight, palm up. Gently pull the fingers back with your other hand.

Palm-down stretch — 15 s each hand
Arm straight, palm down. Gently press the back of the hand toward you.

Tendon glides — 3 rounds
Open hand, hook fist, full fist, flat fist, straight fingers. Slowly, one shape at a time.



4 Hips & back — 1:30

Seated figure-4 — 30 s each side
Ankle on the opposite knee. Sit tall and hinge forward a little until you feel the hip.

Seated twist — 15 s each side
Hold the chair back and turn gently, starting from your upper back.

Keep going

Free routines, the 30-day Desk & Gamer Mobility waitlist and my live schedule: **linktr.ee/kristinemaia**
Twitch: twitch.tv/kristinemaia · Instagram: @kristinemaia11

Hi, I'm Kristine

Sports science graduate, certified recovery massage therapist and mobility & recovery coach. **Not medical advice.** This is general mobility. If you have pain, an injury or a medical condition, check with a doctor first, and stop if anything feels sharp.

Do each move well

Slow and gentle beats big and fast.

9 MOVES EXPLAINED

Page 1 is the routine. This page shows how to do each move well.



Neck

1:20

Chin tucks *8 slow reps*

HOW Sit tall. Slide your chin straight back, as if making a double chin. Keep your head level. Hold 2 seconds, then release.

FEEL A light stretch at the back of your neck.

GENTLER Fewer reps and a smaller glide.

Side neck stretch *20 s each side*

HOW Hold the seat with your right hand. Let your left ear drift toward your left shoulder. Then switch sides.

FEEL A stretch along the side of the neck that is holding the chair.

GENTLER Tilt less. Let the weight of your head do the work, no pulling.



Shoulders

1:00

Shoulder rolls *8 rolls*

HOW Lift your shoulders toward your ears, roll them back, then let them melt down. Big, slow circles, backwards only.

FEEL Your shoulders loosening up with each circle.

GENTLER Smaller circles.

Shoulder blade squeeze *8 reps*

HOW Pull your shoulder blades back and down, as if tucking them into your back pockets. Hold 3 seconds. Keep your neck long.

FEEL The work between your shoulder blades, not in your neck.

GENTLER Hold for 1 to 2 seconds.



Wrists

1:10

Palm-up stretch *15 s each hand*

HOW Arm straight, palm up. With your other hand, gently pull the fingers back toward the floor.

FEEL A stretch along the inside of your forearm. No pain, no tingling.

GENTLER Bend the elbow a little and pull less.

Palm-down stretch

15 s each hand

HOW Arm straight, palm down. Gently press the back of the hand toward you, fingers pointing down.

FEEL A stretch along the top of your forearm.

GENTLER Bend the elbow and press less.

Tendon glides *3 rounds*

HOW Straight hand, hook fist, full fist, flat fist, straight again. One shape at a time, like playing the keyboard in slow motion.

FEEL Smooth, easy movement. Never forced.

GENTLER One hand at a time, slower.



Hips & back

1:30

Seated figure-4 *30 s each side*

HOW Cross one ankle over the opposite knee and flex your foot. Sit tall, then hinge forward from the hips until you feel it.

FEEL A stretch in the outer hip and glute.

GENTLER Stay upright. A small lean is enough.

Seated twist *15 s each side*

HOW Hold the chair back with one hand and your opposite knee with the other. Turn gently, starting from your upper back.

FEEL A mild turn through your upper and mid back. Keep breathing.

GENTLER Turn less and keep your breathing easy.

Three rules for every move

Breathe slowly.
Let the breath out as you go a little deeper.

Stop before it hurts.
A comfortable pull is right. Sharp pain is a stop sign.

Both sides, same effort.
Keep your shoulders relaxed and your jaw soft.

Make it a habit

Short and often is easier to keep than long and rare.

7
DAY CHECK-IN

The 1-minute reset

1:00

- Chin tucks, 4 slow reps
- Shoulder rolls, 4 backwards
- Palm-up stretch, 8 s each hand
- Seated twist, 8 s each side

For the gap between two matches.

The 2-minute version

2:00

- Chin tucks, 6 slow reps
- Side neck stretch, 10 s each side
- Shoulder rolls, 6 backwards
- Palm-up and palm-down stretch, 10 s each hand
- Seated figure-4, 10 s each side

For the top of the hour.

When to do it

Pick one trigger and keep it for a week.

- After every match, queue or meeting
- At the top of each hour, with a repeating timer
- Before you start a stream or a work block
- Any time your neck or hands feel stuck

Your 7-day check-in

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
5-minute routine							
1-minute reset							

How tight does it feel? 0 is not at all, 10 is very tight.

	DAY 1	DAY 7
Neck & shoulders		
Wrists		
Hips & back		

Write your numbers on day 1 and day 7. On day 1 of my 30-day program you rate them again.

What I noticed

What's next

I'm filming a 30-day Desk & Gamer Mobility program: 10 minutes a day, mostly from your chair. You're on the list, so you'll hear first when it's ready. Tell me which spot feels worst by replying to my email. It shapes what I make next.

linktr.ee/kristinemaia · twitch.tv/kristinemaia · @kristinemaia11

Stop signs

Stop if you feel sharp pain, numbness, tingling or dizziness. If it does not settle, check with a doctor. **Not medical advice.** This is general mobility. If you have pain, an injury or a medical condition, check with a doctor first.

Kristine Maia · sports science graduate · certified recovery massage therapist · mobility & recovery coach